

MIT 5600G – Security Policies and Risk Management

Final Group Project – Security Policy

Topic: Corporate Social Media Account Management and Employee Brand Advocacy Organization

Name: MapleMart Retail Group

Group No: 03

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1. Introduction and Technology Overview

This presentation provides an introduction and overview of the technology.

Corporate social media account management is the systematic and systematic management, operation and security of the social media accounts (LinkedIn, X (formerly Twitter), Facebook, Instagram, TikTok) of the organization. This encompasses everything from account setup and credentials to content publishing, engaging audiences, and tracking performance. Employee brand advocacy is another tactic, complementary to employee social media, where employees post or even generate content that has been approved by their company/organization and used to promote the brand to expand reach, trust and attract talent.

These functions are supported by technology, including social media management platforms (Hootsuite, Sprout Social), employee advocacy platforms (DSMN8, Sociabble), identity and access management (IAM) systems and social listening platforms. These platforms enable them to publish the content, monitor engagement and analytics, and even offer ready-made content for staff to share. But the social networking platforms are consumer-based, and that poses serious challenges to enterprise security and governance.

2. Security Risks, Threats, Vulnerabilities and Security Benefits

2.1 Key Security Risks and Threats

Account Takeover and Credential Theft: Social media teams routinely distribute credentials to many people on their team, disable multi-factor authentication and don't change passwords regularly. This makes it a big attack surface. In 2025, the FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center reported 859,532 complaints and losses exceeding \$16 billion; U.S. companies had losses of 9.8% of their revenue due to impersonation-related fraud, up 46% from 2024. This infostealer malware, similar to NodeStealer, robs the browser stored information, hacking business Gmail, Outlook, and Facebook accounts.

Brand Impersonation: Attackers set up fake accounts, impersonating well-known brands, executives, or customer support to trick users. During Q4 2025, Microsoft is the top brand being mimicked, with 22% of all brand phishing attempts being mimicked. Impersonation volume for high-level executive social media accounts rose to over 54% of all impersonation volume in Q3 2025 as impersonation of these accounts on social media hit an all-time high. The use of generative AI tools by threat actors to develop realistic fake pages is growing, and it is often very hard to tell the difference between malicious pages and real ones.

Insider Threats: When employees are unhappy or malicious, they can create negative content for the organization and post it on official organizational accounts. In addition, staff can also unintentionally share information that could be considered sensitive or not secure their own accounts, allowing attackers to enter.

Phishing and Social Engineering: Personae constructed from employee names, titles and personally identifiable information (PII) that are available on social media are used to fake phishing campaigns. Social media networks are the ideal platform to spread malware and hack accounts.

Employee-Generated Content: Employee-generated content can be a risk factor for privacy, security, and legal compliance issues, including data leaks, compliance violations, and reputation damage. Sensitive information, client information or proprietary business techniques can be shared inadvertently by employees.

2.2 Vulnerabilities

Inadequate IT supervision. Social media accounts may be maintained by marketing teams or outsourced organizations, as opposed to IT security teams, making it a security blind spot.

Shared Credentials. If two or more users have the same set of credentials, it can be difficult to find out which ones are suspicious posts or who has taken certain actions.

Inadequate Access Controls. Social platforms are not designed to be used for enterprise access control, making enterprise-level access control setup difficult.

Dormant Accounts. Employee accounts that have been allowed to remain open pose a security threat.

2.3 Security Benefits

These dangers are present, but with proper social media governance, there are several security advantages. With IAM, the company can effectively manage its accounts in a centralized manner, as well as implement policies such as MFA, password rotation, access management, and revocation of access without losing control of the accounts. By employing proper governance, employee advocacy programs can actually help provide hands-on brand engagement while also improving security awareness by educating employees about phishing and good cyber hygiene.

3.Privacy, Legal, Ethical, Regulatory and Compliance Issues

3.1 Regulatory Framework

The Endorsement Guidelines for Advertisers issued by the Federal Trade Commission (FTC). The Federal Trade Commission requires disclosure and honesty if an endorser is in any relationship with a company that might affect his or her endorsement of the company. The fines for non-compliance in 2025 reached a whopping \$53,088 per violation. In June of 2025, the FTC proposed a change to the definition of "endorsement" that would cover "promo codes, affiliate links, and brand tags, for example," and require the disclosure to be "clear and conspicuous" in all media.

Industry-Specific Regulations. Financial services, healthcare and pharmaceutical companies have additional regulatory requirements regarding the content of communication to the public.

3.2 Responsibility and Accountability

The privacy of employees is one of the most crucial issues. There needs to be a balance between businesses' rights to protect their brand and the respecting of employees' social media habits. An employer who wants to monitor an employee's social media accounts should state this clearly to the employee and, generally speaking, it is not acceptable to monitor an employee's accounts covertly.

Ethical issues include programs being voluntary, employees not being coerced, and consistent discipline. When publishing photos of employees or personal information of employees, personal data will be processed, which requires suitable legal bases.

4. Potential Business Impact and Operational Considerations

4.1 Business Impact

Revenue & Brand Equity. In many businesses, social media is the primary marketing tool used and a considerable portion of revenues are driven by the business's success to create brand equity and generate leads as well as attract prospects. If hacked or spoofed, it can have an immediate effect on the bottom line, and be detrimental to the brand reputation in the long term.

Reputational Damage. Hackers would be able to post negative information, update account names or switch accounts to spread messages that would negatively affect the credibility of the organization. Consequences of these incidents can include PR crisis, legal action, operational issues and investigation by shareholder(s).

Attracting and keeping talent. Employees can be the most effective recruiters, particularly when it comes to younger candidates, Gen Z, who tend to be more interested in real employee experiences than polished messaging from companies. Negative employee posts can just as well tarnish employer brand and repel talent, however though.

Regulatory Penalties. If the FTC disclosure rules are not adhered to or data privacy regulations, the consequences are huge. The FTC has been fined a record \$53,088 per violation in 2025 and the GDPR fines can be as high as hundreds of millions of euros

4.2 Operational Considerations

Centralized Governance. There should be a governance Center of Excellence (CoE) within the organisation to govern social media risks. This covers the process for social approvals, training and security threat monitoring.

Access Management. All social media accounts need to be connected to corporate IAM systems for a centralized access to accounts, seamless MFA, compliance with policies, and audit trails. Authorization to publish is required only from the authorized personnel.

Employee Training. The greatest hazards that employees face are ones of lack of knowledge. Phishing Training should involve How to recognize Phishing e-mails, Set up a protection like Two Factor authentication and confirm the photo before sending e-mail.

Content Approval Workflows. Content approval should be set up as a workflow to ensure that the content is accurate and consistent to the brand before publishing. Employees can add authentic content to the pre-approved content libraries and remain brand safe.

Target Company: MapleMart Retail Group

MapleMart Retail Group is a fictional Canadian retail and ecommerce business providing clothing, electronics, home goods and lifestyle products in both brick and mortar retail outlets and online. The business is based in several provinces in Canada and has thousands of users every day via its online platform and mobile app.

Digital marketing and social media engagement are crucial components of MapleMart's business model, with platforms like Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, TikTok, and X playing a significant role. These platforms can be utilized as product promotion, promotions announcement, customer enquiries and enhance the brand image of the company.

In addition, MapleMart promotes its employees' personal use of content that has been approved by the company to raise brand awareness. This can help increase trust with the customer and expand the website's voice.

As social media is an integral part of MapleMart's communication and marketing initiatives, the company must contend with threats like unauthorized access to social media accounts, fake social media brand profiles, accidental

information leaks, and employee misuse of social media profiles. MapleMart has created a series of security policies on account ownership, access control, brand impersonation response, and employee offboarding to mitigate these risks.

POLICY 1: CORPORATE SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNT OWNERSHIP AND GOVERNANCE POLICY

Version	Editor	Purpose	Change Description	Authorized By	Effective Date
1.0	S.Khen, CFO	Primary	Initial Policy Creation	Board of Directors	01-09-2026
1.1	S.Khen, CFO	Added Subsection	Incorporated Section 3.4: Controls for Access by Third-Party Vendors.	Board of Directors	14-11-2026
1.2	S.Khen, CFO	Updated Subsection	Updated Section 4.2: Transition Schedule for Accounts	Senior Management Committee	05-02-2027
–	S.Khen, CFO	Annual Review	No Change	Senior Management Committee	01-07-2027
2.0	Fahan Amid, CISO	Revised Section	Updated Section 2.0 to align with the changes in organizational structure.	Board of Directors	12-09-2027

Version Control

Introduction:

Objective 1: Discuss the Texts and Questions

Social Media are significant communication channels in today's digital world for companies, brand building and communicating with stakeholders. Corporate social media accounts represent the face of the organization and contain everything from followers to content, analytics, and more, which are part of the organization's intellectual property. The aim of this Corporate Social Media Account Ownership and Governance Policy is to provide clear guidelines for the creation, management, ownership and future transfer of all the Corporate Social Media Accounts. This policy provides for the control of access to all accounts set up and/or maintained on behalf of the organization, and ensures that the accounts belong to the company.

This policy is designed to meet or exceed federal and state laws and regulations regarding data privacy, securities and record retention. This policy covers all staff, contract staff and consultants, temporary staff, interns and third parties who create, manage or have access to any corporate social media account.

Objective 2: To articulate the importance of understanding and adherence to policy.

Managing corporate social media accounts is key to protecting the brand, IP and legal interests of the company. This policy is for the knowledge, understanding and compliance of all staff and affiliates dealing with the use of the

corporate social media presence. If you have any questions or require further information please contact the Marketing Department or the Chief Information Security Officer.

Objective 3: To introduce the reader to the document and content

The ownership and management of social media accounts are defined by this policy. There are standards, guidelines, and procedures in place for implementation which provide detailed instructions on how to make an account, how to manage the account and how to transition an account, which support this policy. These documents can be found in our online company library on the Governance page.

Objective 4: If students are not achieving the required standards for the objectives, give them the results of their failure to do so, and explain the exception procedure.

There may be some exceptions to this policy where it will be impractical or where it may be justifiable on business grounds. Exemptions to any requests will be referred to the Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) in writing and include the reasons and advantages of the exemption. The CMO and the Chief Operating Officer (COO) may approve waivers, as appropriate.

Objective 5: Be grateful to the reader and give a seal of authority.

Thanks in advance for your support in keeping our digital assets safe, secure and our presence online intact.

The Project is in the following stage:

Policy Heading

Section 1: Corporate Social Media Account Ownership and Governance

Section 1 focuses on the ownership and objectives. A corporate social media account. Section 1 is about the ownership and governance of a corporate social media account.

The policy's goals and objectives

This policy aims to:

The aims and intentions of the policy

This policy aims to:

To make sure all corporate social media channels are clearly designated.

-To set up procedures for creation of new Corporate Social Media accounts and approval of the same.

-To guarantee the correct access control and credential tracking.

-To avoid breach of corporate IP and corporate property.

-To ensure clean transfers of accounts on employee's departure from the company.

-To ensure regulatory record-keeping requirements are met.

Policy Statement

1.1 Account Creation and Approval

1.1.1. The Marketing Department will not have a corporate social media account unless it is given written permission.

1.1.2. New social media accounts are to be requested via the official account request form, and must include reasons for the account, proposed account name and intended audience.

1.1.3. All requests for the creation of an account will be reviewed by the Marketing Department who will approve or deny as appropriate in consultation with Legal and/or IT as required.

1.1.4. All corporate social media accounts should be set up with corporate email addresses and have the corporate branding (as stated in the Brand Style Guide) as part of the account.

1.2 Account Ownership

- 1.2.1. Use of the corporate social media account applies only to the organisation and all activities, followers, connections and analytics are solely the property of the organisation.
- 1.2.2. There is no personal ownership rights of any corporate social media account for any individual employee of the company, even if he created or is managing the social media account of the corporate.
- 1.2.3. The Primary Owner and at least 1 Backup Owner shall be designated for each of the corporate social media accounts in the corporate account management system.
- 1.2.4. The Primary Owner will post, engage and monitor the account on a day to day basis.
- 1.2.5. The Backup Owner is to have knowledge of the account and be able to assume management of the account in the event of the Primary Owner's unavailability.

1.3.This includes how to manage access control and credentials.This includes credential and access control management.

- 1.3.1. The corporate social media accounts will be made available on a need to know basis, and solely to those who have a need to access the accounts as a part of their job duties.
- 1.3.2. If the organization has a password management system approved by the organization, the login information for the organization's social media accounts should be in the organization's password management system, and not be sent in email or IM or other insecure methods.
- 1.3.3. Each corporate social media account that has the multi-factor authentication (MFA) option shall be enabled with MFA.
- 1.3.4. Access rights will be reviewed quarterly by the Marketing Department to ensure that access is provided to only authorised users.
- 1.3.5. All employees who have access to the corporate social media accounts are required to take social media governance training every year.

1.4 Account Security

- 1.4.1. Regularly checking a corporate social media account for any unauthorized entry, suspicious activity or security breaches is crucial.
- 1.4.2. In case a security incident is suspected in the company's social media account, it will be reported to the IT Security team at once.
- 1.4.3. Every employee who has access to corporate social media passwords should be given a new password, as soon as he or she leaves the company.
- 1.4.4. Where there is a verification programme on the social media platform, corporate social media accounts should be verified.

Policy Exceptions

Exceptions to this account creation approval policy are allowed if it is a time-sensitive marketing campaign, provided that it is formally approved by the Chief Marketing Officer within 5 business days.

If an account is only used for internal communication and collaboration (e.g., a private Slack channel, private Microsoft Teams channel) it is not subject to the public social media account governance requirements of this policy, unless it reflects the organisation in a public manner.

Policy Enforcement Clause

Consequences of breach of this policy could result in disciplinary measures being taken (dismissal for interns and volunteers, termination of employment relations for contractors and consultants, dismissal for employees and temporaries). In addition, an individual could be subject to civil and criminal prosecution. Any breaches will be recorded, and a note of discipline added to the member's personnel record.

Administrative Notations

Regulatory Cross-Reference

Compliance with Data Privacy Laws (GDPR, CCPA), SEC Regulation FD, FINRA Social Media Guidelines

Lead Author

CFO, Chief Financial Officer: S.Khen, s.khen@example.com

Corresponding Documents

All tenets of social media access control, brand style guide, and record retention policy must be strictly adhered to.All tenets of social media access control, brand style guide and record retention policy must be followed.

Supportive documentation

The process for creating accounts, transferring accounts and revoking access are discussed.The creation and access revocation procedures and the account transition procedure are discussed.

Policy Definitions

Corporate Social Media Account: Any social media account created, managed or operated by the organization (including but not limited to) Facebook, X (formerly Twitter), LinkedIn, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube and other social media platforms.

Primary Owner: The individual who owns a particular corporate social media page or account and is most responsible for its day-to-day use and content.

Backup Owner: A person who will be given the authority to take over the responsibilities of management of a corporate social media account if the Primary Owner is unavailable.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA): The two or more factors that users must use to log in to an account.

Social Media Governance: Policies, processes, roles and controls that guide an organization's use of social media

POLICY 2: EMPLOYEE SOCIAL MEDIA BRAND ADVOCACY POLICY

Version Control:

Version	Editor	Purpose	Change Description	Authorized By	Effective Date
1.0	S.Khen, CFO	Primary	Initial Policy Creation	Board of Directors	01-09-2026
1.1	S.Khen, CFO	Added Subsection	Original The initial policy is created	Board of Directors	14-11-2026
1.2	S.Khen, CFO	Updated Subsection	Content Sharing and Personalization Guidelines	Senior Management Committee	05-02-2027
–	S.Khen, CFO	Annual Review	No Change	Senior Management Committee	01-07-2027
2.0	Fahan Amid, CISO	Revised Section	Compliance and Regulatory	Board of Directors	12-09-2027

Introduction

Objective 1: Give context and meaning

If your employees are sharing your brand's message on their social networks, it can be a wonderful way to get your message out there, build trust and attract the best. Employee generated content works better than content generated by the organization, and has been shown to be more interesting. This Employee Social Media Brand Advocacy Policy provides guidelines for employees who have chosen to join in the work of the organization's brand advocacy mission, so that they may share content from the organization without potential legal or reputational liability while also avoiding potential legal or reputational liability for the organization.

This policy has been created to promote and facilitate staff advocacy and create guidelines for acceptable behaviour. The policy will be observed by all employees participating in the organisation's brand advocacy initiative, all employees who are mentioning the organisation or representing the organisation on their own social media accounts.

Objective 2: Communicate the need to be aware of and follow the policy

The social team is so enriched by the addition of employee advocacy and it's also a part of our employer branding. However, all employees who participate in advocacy should be made aware of, understand and abide by this policy. Please direct any enquiries or questions to the Marketing Department if you require further information or have any questions.

Objective 3: Give the reader an introduction to the document and its content

This policy clarifies the guidelines for employee brand advocacy -- what's OK, what to share, and what is expected. This policy is supported by implementation guidelines and training materials which contain detailed instructions on how to be involved in the advocacy program. These documents can be viewed in our online company library, in the Governance section.

Objective 4: Explain the consequences of noncompliance as well as the exception process

Where practicable or appropriate, it is not possible to do in line with this policy, then employees should consult their manager and/or Marketing Department. Disciplinary action will be taken if this policy is deliberately breached, and may include the termination of employment relations with contractors and consultants, and termination of employment for employees/temporaries.

Objective 5: Give the reader thanks and a "seal of authority".

Thanks for any assistance you can give us around our organisation and brand visibility online.

— Anthony Starks, Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

Policy Heading

Section 2: Creative Forward Thinking

Define the goals and objectives of policy.

Outline the aims and objectives of policy.

This policy aims to:

- To motivate and empower staff to be social media brand ambassadors.To encourage and motivate employees to promote the brand using social media.
- To provide clarity to employees regarding acceptable behavior with social media.
- To protect the organization's brand and IP protection.
- To make sure that laws and regulations are adhered to.
- To establish guidelines on disclosure of employee advocacy activities

Policy Statement

2.1. Brand Advocacy Program participation.

2.1.1. Everyone in the organization is welcome to get involved in the organization's brand advocacy program.

2.1.2. Before posting any company related content on their personal social media, those employees who do choose to advocate should be trained to advocate, just as the staff of any organization is trained to service equipment.

2.1.3. Staff members are encouraged to promote company-approved material via the company's advocacy environment, or its pre-sanctioned material library.

2.1.4. Staff have the opportunity to create materials of their own about their organisation (in line with these guidelines outlined in this policy).

2.2 General Conduct Guidelines

2.2.1. Representing and/or talking about the organization on social media, employees must always be polite, respectful and professional.

2.2.2. In some cases, employees are not allowed to post content which may be racist, racist-related, insulting or otherwise damaging to the reputation of the organization.

2.2.3. Employees are not to disclose any information that could be considered confidential, proprietary, or non-public information regarding the organization, its clients or its business activities.

2.2.4. It is important that staff recognise their professional judgement and exercise caution when posting on the organisation.

2.3 Disclosure and Transparency

2.3.1. If the employee posts content that is related to or references the organization, the employee should clearly show his employment with the organization.

2.3.2. When talking about the organization or its products or services: "Views expressed are my own and do not necessarily reflect those of my employer" should be used as a sample disclaimer.

2.3.3. Any disclosure requirements shall be adhered to including federal trade commission (FTC) guidelines on Endorsements and Testimonials.

2.3.4. Staff are not allowed to post any logos, branding or trademarks of an official organisation without prior permission on their own social media accounts.

2.4 Personalisation and content sharing

This course will emphasize the use of content to share and adjust to the specific needs of individual students.

2.4.1. Staff members are encouraged to publish from the organization's approved content site or organization's advocacy site.

2.4.2. Staff may record their own opinions about shared material as long as it is within the guidelines for appropriate conduct as specified in Section 2.2.

2.4.3. Staff should always verify all content posted and make sure to not give any false impression or false information.

2.4.4. The workers need to quote sources and attribute their credit.

2.5 Privacy and Confidentiality

2.5.1. Employees should not divulge details about employees, clients or customers without their permission.

2.5.2. At all times employees must ensure the client/customer information is kept confidential and should not disclose any information that could identify either a client or a customer.

2.5.3. Staff need to be mindful that their social media accounts may be accessed for extended periods of time, and that they may be accessed during court trials.

2.6 Avoiding problems with personal and professional accounts.

2.6.1. Where possible employees are encouraged to use their own personal and professional social media accounts.

2.6.2. When an employee personalizes their comments about work issues, it is to be clearly labeled as such and not the employee's.

2.6.3. Employees should not use their own personal social media accounts to post any official symbols, logos or branding of their organization.

2.7 Prohibited Content

- 2.7.1. Posting of material which can be interpreted as the official position of an organization on political, religious or social issues is not allowed unless authorized.
- 2.7.2. None of the employees are allowed to discuss or argue with anyone about the organization.
- 2.7.3. Employees are not to breach intellectual property (IP) rights, such as copyright and trademark.
- 2.7.4. Employees should not post anything that may be in violation of securities laws, such as disclosure of material non-public information.

Policy Exceptions

Employees who are authorized and designated as official spokesperson and posting in their official capacity will not be required to disclose in section 2.3.

If it is a legal or regulatory requirement for an employee to maintain a social media account (such as for some licensed employees) some provisions of this policy may not be applicable unless approved in advance by Legal Department.

Policy Enforcement Clause

Staff and/or temporary employees may be challenged and, if applicable, dismissed from employment, contractors and consultants could have their contracts terminated, interns and volunteers could be terminated from their relationships. Any infractions will be reported, and the disciplinary action placed in the employee's personnel file.

Administrative Notations

Regulatory Cross-Reference

Contains FTC Endorsement Guidelines, SEC Regulation FD, Data Privacy Laws (GDPR, CCPA), and NLRB Social Media Guidance.

Lead Author

Please send a cover letter to s.khen@example.com, Chief Financial Officer for example.com.

Corresponding Documents

These include a code of conduct, a social media style guide and brand advocacy guidelines. A code of conduct, social media style guide and brand advocacy guidelines are offered.

Supportive documentation

Employee Handbook; Training materials. The Advocacy Program Enrollment procedure, Content Sharing procedure are related procedures.

Policy Definitions

Employee Brand Advocacy: When employees post positive messages about their company on their personal social media, it can generate greater brand awareness and trust in the brand.

Someone who chooses to interact with their social media as a representative of the organization.

Pre-approved Content Library: A list of social media text provided by an organization that employee-supporters can post in the advocacy platform.

The practice of explicitly mentioning the affiliation with the employer in the publication of content that is related or references the employer.

Material Non-Public Information: Information that would be material to the pricing of an organization's stock or investment decision and has not been made public.

POLICY 3: BRAND IMPERSONATION DETECTION AND RESPONSE POLICY

Version control :

Version	Editor	Purpose	Change Description	Authorized By	Effective Date
1.0	Fahan Amid, CISO	Primary	Initial release for general use	Board of Directors	01-09-2026
1.1	Fahan Amid, CISO	Added Subsection	Section 4.3: Data Export and Transfer Procedures added to the Program	Senior Management Committee	14-11-2026
1.2	Fahan Amid, CISO	Updated Subsection	Account Transition Timelines is included at subsection 1.2	Board of Directors	05-02-2027
–	Fahan Amid, CISO	Annual Review	No Change	Senior Management Committee	01-07-2027
2.0	Fahan Amid, CISO	Revised Section	Section 5.0: Security Considerations for Account Transition	Senior Management Committee	12-09-2027

Introduction

Objective 1: Provide background and explanation:

Nowadays, social media is a huge issue for any business in the world, especially as it keeps growing. The number of brand impersonation attacks went up by 42% in 2024 and now represent 51% of all phishing attacks on the web. They make up fake accounts using legitimate brands, executives, recruiters or support teams to lure users to provide information. This Brand Impersonation Detection and Response Policy aims to establish a consistent, enterprise-wide policy to detect, confirm and thwart brand impersonation on social media channels.

This policy has been developed to safeguard our organisation's brand reputation, customers, employees and stakeholders against the damage caused by impersonation attacks.

Objective 2: Raise awareness and awareness of the policy.

Impersonation attacks will follow soon and our brand will be assessed as it happens. Any staff member who discovers the attempted impersonation should notify the proper staff immediately via the proper channels. Please speak to the IT Security team if you have any questions or more information.

Objective 3: Introduce the reader to the document and its content

With a learning objective of to acquaint the reader with the document and its contents, it is imperative to introduce them first.

This policy describes the processes that will be used to recognise and respond to incidents of brand impersonation. This policy is backed by procedures for implementation that detail the incident triage, validation, containment and takedown procedures in detail. These documents can be accessed in our online company library, within the Governance area.

Objective 4: Provide a description of what the consequences of not meeting the requirement(s) and the exception process will be.

There are no exceptions to this policy, the response is key to safeguarding our brand and stakeholders when it comes to impersonation threats. Employees and temporaries who willfully fail to report incidents of known impersonation may be subject to disciplinary action which can include termination.

When you are writing to thank the reader and you want to give your document an authoritative seal, it is important to follow 5 objectives. Thanks for your proactive actions and cooperation towards protecting our brand from impersonation threats!

Below is a quote from Anthony Starks, Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

Policy Heading:

Section 3: Detecting and responding to brand impersonation attacks.

Policy Goals and Objectives

The goals and objectives of this policy are to:

- To set up a proactive brand impersonation monitoring programme
- To define boundaries and responsibilities of impersonation response.
- To help make prompt identification and closing of accounts pretending to be you possible.
- To prevent impersonation fraud targeting customers, employees and stakeholders.
- To maintain the brand trust and brand reputation.
- To record and learn the lessons from impersonation events.

Policy Statement

3.1 Proactive Monitoring

3.1.1. The IT Security team (in collaboration with the Marketing Department) will continuously monitor for brand impersonation on all major social media.

3.1.2. The following social media will be monitored (not limited to): Facebook, X (or Twitter), LinkedIn, Instagram, TikTok and YouTube.

3.1.3. The organisation shall implement automatic monitoring and manual checking mechanisms to detect potential impersonation attempts.

3.1.4. Monitored parameters are executive names, brand names, product names and customer support aliases.

3.2 Detection and Identification

3.2.1. The following indicators will be used to determine if a brand has been impersonated:

- a. Unauthorized accounts with organisation's name, logo and/or branding.
- b. Hidden accounts utilizing executive names, a title or profile. Disguised accounts using executive name, title or profile.
- c. Accounts claiming to be customer support or recruitment accounts.
- d. An official account's username or handle that is similar to another person's. An account that has a similar account name/handle to an official account.
- e. All accounts associated with phishing, credential theft or fraudulent activity.

3.2.2. If an employee sees potential impersonation accounts, it must be reported to the IT Security team as soon as it is discovered.

3.2.3. Any individual – including customers, partners and other stakeholders – who raise suspicions of impersonation should be recognised, and their concerns taken seriously and dealt with promptly.

3.3 Incident triage and validation

3.3.1. When the IT Security team notice a possible impersonation incident, they will do a preliminary checkup to determine if the incident is a threat.

3.3.2. Validation will be undertaken to confirm that the following has been completed:

- a. The asset is up and running.
- b. The brand elements in the account are an association indicator.
- c. There is a conversion step that is there to get value out of victims
- d. Some support from customer feedback or otherwise provided

3.3.3. There will be an incident owner for each incident that has been verified to be an impersonation incident.

3.3.4. The level of severity and urgency of the incident shall be judged by the organisation's incident severity classification system.

3.4 Response and Takedown

3.4.1. The incident owner will start the incident response process within 30 minutes of incident validation.

3.4.2. These are some activities to use for the response:

- a. Evidence Gathering: Screenshots, URLs, redirections, account info. etc.
- b. The impersonating account is reported to the platform provider via the reporting procedures provided with the Platform.
- c. Communicate with appropriate internal stakeholders as needed
- d. Sending out customer warnings if customers are exposed to risk.

3.4.3. The Marketing Department shall prepare and distribute customer communications relating to incidents that might impact customers.

3.4.4. The Legal Department will be involved in trademark infringement, fraud and/or potential legal concerns.

3.5 AI-Enhanced Detection

3.5.1. The organization shall make use of AI and machine learning tools for enhanced impersonation detection.

3.5.2. Automated detection systems shall be designed to alert to accounts that have impersonation characteristics so they can be reviewed by humans.

3.5.3. The detection capabilities of AI will be continuously updated to stay relevant to the latest trend and techniques of impersonation.

3.6 Documentation and Reporting

3.6.1. All impersonation events should be recorded (how it was detected, what was discovered, what action was taken and what were the results).

3.6.2. Incident reports will be stored at least for seven years to ensure that there is a legal and regulatory requirement.

3.6.3. A report of impersonation incidents will be provided quarterly to the Board of Directors and senior management.

3.6.4. Lessons learned from impersonation experiences will be incorporated into training and detections will be improved.

3.7 Training and Awareness

- 3.7.1. All staff to be trained every year on how to recognise and report brand impersonation.
- 3.7.2. Customer facing staff to be provided with extra training on dealing with customer complaints about impersonations.
- 3.7.3. The organisation will have publicly available information on the ways that customers can recognise legitimate versus impersonating accounts.

Policy Exceptions

This policy has no exceptions as timely and consistent response to impersonation threats is key to the protection of our brand and stakeholders. Any incident in which someone tries to impersonate another student, staff member or school official should be investigated and responded to in accordance with this policy.

Policy Enforcement Clause

Failure to report any impersonation (known or not) by any employee or temporary or failure to follow the procedures set out in this policy, including termination of employment may be deemed to be disciplinary action. Any contractor, consultant or employment relations who is aware of an incident that they know is an impersonation incident or if they do report an incident who does not follow the procedures outlined in this policy may be terminated. Failure of contractors, consultants and interns and volunteers to report any incident that they are aware of being an impersonation or failure to follow the procedures set out in this policy if a report is made could lead to their dismissal.

Administrative Notations

Regulatory Cross-Reference

The FTC Guidelines, the Trademark Law, the Data Privacy Laws and Anti-Phishing Regulations.

Lead Author

The name of the organisation displayed is the Chief Information Security Officer (CISSO) of the organisation. Lead Author – Name of the CISO of the organisation.

Incident Response Plan/Corresponding Documents

Social Media Security Standard, and Brand Protection Guidelines are the documents that correspond to this.

Supporting Documents

These are all examples of files that can be used for platform reporting procedures and customer communication templates.

Apply to procedures above. Please refer to the following procedures: Related Procedures Impersonation Reporting Procedure, Takedown Request Procedure, Customer Notification Procedure.

Policy Definitions

Brand Impersonation: Creating fake accounts or fake pages that will look like genuine brands, executives or employees for phishing, fraud or reputation management purposes.

Phishing: Phishing is a form of cyber attack in which a link appears to be from a trusted source to trick the user to give away personal data such as usernames/passwords.

Triage: Initial assessment of an attempted impersonation incident to see if it is a true incident, serious and what actions are needed to appropriately respond to an attempted impersonation.

Takedown: If the pretending account is deleted or disabled by the platform provider.

Incident Owner: The person tasked to handle the management of an incident of impersonation from the time it is detected until it is resolved.

POLICY 4: EMPLOYEE SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNT TRANSITION AND TERMINATION POLICY

Version control :

Version	Editor	Purpose	Change Description	Authorized By	Effective Date
1.0	S.Khen, CFO	Primary	Initial release for general use	Board of Directors	01-09-2026
1.1	S.Khen, CFO	Added Subsection	Procedure for AI-enhanced Detection	Board of Directors	14-11-2026
1.2	S.Khen, CFO	Updated Subsection	Revised 4.0 Timeframe for Responding	Board of Directors	05-02-2027
–	S.Khen, CFO	Annual Review	No Change	Senior Management Committee	01-07-2027
2.0	Fahan Amid, CISO	Revised Section	Enhancing Section 5.0 Requirements of reporting and documentation	Senior Management Committee	12-09-2027

Introduction

Objective 1: Give context & meaning

The transfer of corporate social media accounts is a complex and critical process that is important for ensuring the continuity of business, protecting business assets and maintaining communication with followers and connections when employees are leaving the organization. Lacking a proper transition and termination process, organizations could end up losing out on valuable social media accounts, content, and follower relationship. This Employee Social Media Account Transition and Termination Policy's intent is to provide clear guidelines on how to handle the transition of the company's social media accounts when an employee changes roles within the company or has left the company.

Objective 2: To relay the policy and value of the policy.

It is crucial that if an employee leaves, his/her accounts are dealt with properly, to prevent a significant loss of continuity in the business and of our digital assets. The job of every staff member that deals with corporate social media is to help make the switch between the two easy. Contact the Human Resources Department or the Marketing department for further information and/or any questions.

Objective 3: Communicate the document and what it contains to the reader.

This policy will be utilized as the framework for implementing a policy in regards to the transfer of company social media accounts when employees leave the company. Procedures are in place in support of this policy, providing information to assist their transition. The documents can be downloaded online from our Governance section.

Objective 4: Describe the implications for not complying with standards and the exception process.

There may be exceptions of this policy where practicability is not possible due to exceptional circumstances. Exceptions will be made at the discretion of the Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) and the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) by submitting a written request. Disciplinary measures will be taken and liability for damages may be held against the individual who caused the violation in the event of a violation of this Policy.

Objective 5: Thank the reader and give the reader a seal of authority

We appreciate your cooperation with us in making our social media assets a smooth transition.

Anthony Starks, Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

Policy Heading

The Employee Social Media Account Transition and Termination section describes how to end and/or transition an employee's social media accounts.

Policy Goals and Objectives

This policy aims to:

To ensure all aspects of corporate social media accounts are controlled

-To set up clear procedures for employee to employee transition of accounts.

-To ensure the continuity of the relationships with followers, contents and analytics information.

-To ensure the survival of the business on social media activities. To ensure the continuity of businesses in social media.

-To make sure that company accounts are not accessed by unauthorized people post resignation.

Policy Statement

4.1A. Disaster Risk Management Plan -

4.1.1. If you are an employee who handles the company's social media accounts, report your resignation to your supervisor and the Marketing Department 2 weeks before the resignation date (if possible).

4.1.2. The Marketing Department will start the process of transitioning an account when notified of an employee's resignation.

4.1.3. Each corporate social media account the employee will be responsible for will have a transition plan.

4.1.4. The transition plan should designate who succeeds each of the accounts.

4.2 Account Transition

4.2.1. All corporate social media accounts that the departing employee has should be transferred to the designated successor(s) before the departing employee's last working day.

4.2.2. In the transition, the following will occur and be a part of the process, including but not limited to:

a. Designated successors shall be given administrative access in the event of their occurrence.

b. This includes sharing the content calendars, schedules and planned posts. This is the sharing of the content plan, schedules and planned posts.

d. Sharing audience information, analytics and performance data

d. Record of account-specific standards, procedures and best practices.

e. Briefing on current campaigns, initiatives and engagements.

4.2.3. The staff member departing shall pass on all the log in information to the manager or delegated staff member.

4.2.4. The employee who is being terminated shall assist in training any other employees who are assigned to assume his or her duties as needed for the specific accounts.

4.3 Export and transfer data for analysis or other purposes.

4.3.1. Content posted by the organization (including images, videos, and other content) shall be the property of the organization.

4.3.2. The person who is leaving the organization does not have permission to delete, modify or move any organization content without authority.

4.3.3. The organization shall export and store analytics data, follower data and engagement data.

4.3.4. The leaving employee will ensure that any external tools, platforms or services which are used for managing the accounts, are made available.

4.4 Access Revocation

4.4.1. The rights of access should be terminated with the employee when they leave the company.

4.4.2. The IT Security team will ensure that all access is revoked and the employee is not able to access any corporate social media account.

4.4.3. When the employee leaves the company, all of his/her corporate social media accounts (whether they use them or not) will be changed with a new password.

4.4.4. The multi-factor authentication settings shall be modified to remove the employee's methods of authentication who is departing.

4.5 Account Review and Audit

4.5.1. CSRMA will be audited within 30 days of employee's departure for any corporate social media account that's being managed by the departing employee.

4.5.2. The audit will include the following:

a. No new content is added, deleted or modified in the existing content.

b. Access has been adequately transferred

c. No changes unauthorized.

4.5.3. If discrepancies are found in the course of the audit these will be reported to the Marketing Department and the IT Security team.

4.6 Departing Employee Responsibilities

4.6.1. The departing employee will not remove any organization owned social media content, contacts and information from the organization at the time of their departure.

4.6.2. No social media will be allowed to be used by the employee who is leaving the organization after his or her last day of work in the organization.

4.6.3. Leaving employee will not use social media post leaving the company in any way that misrepresents or deceives the company.

4.6.4. They will be returning any company supplied device which may have social media credentials or access information.

4.7 Deleting and archiving accounts.

4.7.1. The inactive accounts will be either deactivated or archived and the successors will be deleted from the inactive accounts.

4.7.2. Deactivation and archiving shall be based on the organization's record retention policy.

4.7.3. Archived accounts will be kept for as long as necessary as per applicable laws and regulations.

4.7.4. If there is no owner of an account, it cannot be left unlocked, or else it can be accessed by others and it can be broken into.

4.8 : Review the Legal implications and requirements of Legal Hold and Litigation.

4.8.1. A Litigation Hold notice will be given for any litigation known to or expected by the organization.

4.8.2. The content of social media posts, direct messages, and metadata that are a part of the dispute should be kept and not deleted or litigated held.

4.8.3. Any potentially relevant Social Media content should not be deleted from or archived without input from the Legal Department.

Policy Exceptions

an exception can be put in place when it is not practicable to comply with this policy due to exceptional circumstances for example if an employee leaves their role without them it is not practicable. Exceptions will be made on a written application to the Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) and the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) within five business days of the departure.

Policy Enforcement Clause

Disciplinary action, which could include termination for employees and temporaries, termination of employment relations for contractors/consultants or dismissal for interns/volunteers, may apply for willful violation of this policy. Moreover, the ones caught stealing IP or using it without authorization can be held civilly and criminally liable for

theft of IP and/or unauthorized use.

Administrative Notations

Regulatory Cross-Reference

Take on average 40 minutes. Average time: 40 minutes.

Lead Author

The Chief Financial Officer (CFO), s.khen@example.com

Plan for responding to incidents and supporting documents

Plan for responding to incidents / supporting documents.

Document Security Settings, Record Security, Access Control Standard.

Supporting Documents

Employment Contracts, Ownership Agreements for Social Media and IT Security Policies.

Conduct Review of the Account Transition Procedure, Access Revocation Procedure, Litigation Hold Procedure

Policy Definitions

Account Transition: Transferring management and control of a company's social media presence to a designated successor when the previous manager/owner is departing.

Successor: Person determined to take over management of a corporate social media account when an employee leaves.

Access Revocation: Denying someone access to corporate social media accounts.

Litigation Hold: A court order which does not allow the destruction of all records and communications that may be relevant to the litigious action.

Account Deactivation: When a corporate social media account is deactivated with the option to reactivate when needed.

Account archiving: Social media archiving involves storing social media content and data for an extended period of time, to ensure proper record-keeping and compliance with legal and regulatory obligations.

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